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Computer Engineering

Company: UBS
Job Profile: Graduate Trainee
Offer Type: Internship + Placement
Internship Stipend: 60k
CTC: 14.5 LPA (12.5 + 2)
Location: Pune / Hyderabad
Process Date: 10/07/25 (PPT + OA)
14/07/25 (Interviews)

Placement Process:

1. Online Assessment
2. Technical Round
3. Technical Round
4. HR Round

1. Online Assessment + UBS Campus Hackathon

I had taken part in the UBS Campus Hackathon in April 2025, So as a finalist, I got a direct exemption from the online assessment for campus placements at UBS — straight to the interview round. To get into the hackathon, the first step was clearing an online assessment which in March. It was a 50-minute test with MCQs on Java and core CS subjects like DSA, OOP, DBMS, and OS, along with one coding question. The coding part was varied for each student, like there was a set of 4–5 questions, and anyone could get any one of them. Mine was manageable, and I was able to solve it completely.

From our college, 11 students got shortlisted for the main hackathon round. UBS had made really good arrangements — from food and logistics to event flow. Teams were randomly formed with 6 members each, and although all of my teammates were from SPIT, we were all complete strangers. It felt a bit awkward at first, but it turned out to be a great experience — collaborating with new people helped break the ice quickly.

Each team had 3–4 mentors assigned, and they rotated throughout the day. All of them were approachable and gave useful feedback from time to time. One of the mentors took a special

interest in our project , just asking us to explain our part, our thought process, and what our plan was and all.

Our problem statement was about solving the teacher shortage in some rural schools by building a smart platform that connects volunteers with schools and students. It was exciting to work on something with real-world impact and see how tech can be used for social good. The feedback from mentors and UBS professionals helped us refine our ideas and presentation.

If you get the chance to participate, go for it. And if participating, make the most of those interactions, ask questions, share your progress, and take their suggestions seriously. Be open, interact with your team, make the most of mentor sessions, and enjoy the whole experience — not just the coding part. It's a great mix of learning, networking, and fun. :)

2. **Technical Interview** [20 candidates were shortlisted]

The technical interview process started around 10 AM, and each interview lasted approximately 45 minutes to 1 hour. My interview went on for about 50 minutes and was conducted by a panel of 2 interviewers.

It began with a basic introduction, followed by a resume walkthrough. They went through my achievements and then moved on to my projects. I was asked to explain one of my main projects in detail. The questions that followed included:

- Is it an individual or group project?
- What was your role and contribution?
- How did you come up with the idea?
- Business-oriented questions like:
 - How would you scale the project?
 - Would a subscription model work for your application?
 - Why would a user choose your app?
 - How would you handle randomness in the generated results?
- Tech-specific questions like:
 - Why did you choose this tech stack?

After project-related questions, they gave me a few real-world scenarios. For example:

- *"If you're building a loan allocation model, how would you prevent it from being biased based on gender, age, caste, etc.?"*
This led to a few follow-up questions based on the approach I explained.
- Another scenario: *"If you're building an e-commerce platform, what modules would you include? What all aspects would you focus on? And how would you divide the work among a team of three?"*

Next, I was asked some technical/conceptual questions:

- Minimum 5 key differences between C, C++, and Java
- Some DevOps-related questions
- Questions on frontend frameworks — which ones I've worked with, and whether I've used Angular

They also asked a couple of classic puzzle questions to assess logical thinking:

- The 8-ball puzzle (find the heavier ball using minimum weighings)
- A father-child age puzzle (when will the father be thrice the child's age)

At the end, make sure to ask them a few questions as well. It's a good way to show interest and curiosity:

- I asked about their roles at UBS and how their journeys had evolved in the company.
- I also asked about UBS's innovation initiatives, specifically in the areas of blockchain and AI.

3. Technical Interview

I had another round of interview which was more of a techno-behavioral (tech + HR) round. It lasted about 40–45 minutes and this time there was just one interviewer.

The round started with a basic introduction, followed by a detailed walkthrough of my resume. Interestingly, the interviewer asked me to narrate my journey as a story — starting from school up to getting into SPIT. While I shared my story, he interrupted occasionally with questions about the decisions I had made along the way, just to understand my approach and reasoning behind them. He asked me whether I was fine with relocation or not.

Then we discussed one of my notable hackathon wins — the Smart India Hackathon. He asked:

- What did you build?
- What was the overall journey like?
- What challenges did you face?
- How many team members were involved?
- What was your specific contribution?

After that, the round became more analytical with a set of 4 puzzle questions:

1. Two candles, each take 1 hour to burn — how would you use them to measure 45 minutes? - [link](#)
2. Bridge puzzle — 4 people with different speeds, 1 torch, 2-person limit: how to cross with minimum total time? - [link](#)
3. Poisoned bottle puzzle — 1000 bottles, 1 is poisoned, you have 10 test strips: how to find the poisoned one in minimum time? - [link](#)
4. 2 eggs, 100-floor building — from which floor will the egg not break? - [link](#)

At the end of the interview, I asked him about his **journey to UBS** and his **current role** at the company and How does UBS support internal mobility — switching teams, locations, or

roles?... it went like a normal discussion where the interviewer shared his complete journey with me.

3. HR Interview [10-11 candidates where shortlisted]

My HR round was conducted just five minutes after my second technical interview and was quite simple and fast unlike other HR interview rounds. It was a pleasant surprise when the HR greeted me with a smile, mentioning I was a “known face” , likely because of the interaction during the UBS hackathon. That instantly made the interaction feel more relaxed.

The questions were more of a background check than a deep HR evaluation. She asked:

- Where I stay
- How my technical rounds went and what kind of questions I was asked
- Details about my internships — what I did, whether they were paid or unpaid

We also spoke briefly about my hackathon experience and how I contributed to the team.

While it may have felt informal, I understand the importance of playing this round carefully. HR rounds often assess not just communication skills, but also culture fit, clarity, and honesty. Keeping a genuine smile, staying confident, and being authentic helped maintain a positive impression throughout.

6 students were offered the role and I was one of them :).

Useful Tips:

- 1. Maintain a Balance between DSA and Development Skills-** It's important to have a balance between (DSA) and development skills. As Companies like UBS can ask questions from either area—or both—depending on the interviewer’s background. So, ensure that you're prepared with core CS concepts, practical development knowledge, and also practice solving **logical puzzles**, as these are frequently asked to assess your analytical thinking.
- 2. Know Your Resume—But Also Know the Why-** Don't just memorize what's on your resume—be prepared to *reason every line*. Have solid, well-thought-out reasons for every project, internship, or achievement listed. Be ready to explain your decision-making process and choices (e.g., why you chose a particular tech stack, what your contribution was in a team project, etc.).

Tip: Tailor your prep based on the company’s JD and recent trends. For example, during our time, *everything somehow looped back to AI*—so having at least one AI-anchored use case or understanding really helped. Keep an eye on what's hot in the industry and align your resume or project examples accordingly.

3. Ask Smart, Genuine Questions- Interviews are a two-way street. Asking insightful questions (e.g., about the interviewer's role, company innovation, or tech culture) shows that you're truly interested and not just trying to land a job.

4. Participate in Hackathons—Especially Company-Specific Ones

General hackathons help you get comfortable with ideation, teamwork, and presenting under pressure. This will prepare you well for **company-specific hackathons**, which are more than just coding competitions—they're also a chance to **understand the company culture, network with employees, and demonstrate your compatibility**.

Tip: Don't be disheartened by rejections. There's always a factor of timing and luck involved, so keep showing up and learning from each experience.

5. Last but Not the Least — Communication is the Salt- Like salt in food — unnoticed but essential. You may know everything, but if you can't express it well, it won't land. So practice speaking about your work, projects, and decisions. Give mock interviews. Talk to friends, mentors, and seniors. Record yourself explaining concepts(i personally did this very much to know how i should express). The more you speak, the more confident and structured you'll become.

Force yourself to get comfortable with being uncomfortable. That's how you grow.

Resources I followed:

1. DSA: [Striver's A2Z DSA Sheet](#) , [neetcode](#)
2. SQL: [SQL 50](#)
3. OOPS, DBMS, CCN, OS: refer quick one shot and GeeksforGeeks
4. Puzzles: [InterviewBit](#), [interviewKickStart](#) , [GeeksforGeeks](#)

My resume that i used in UBS: [Resume](#)

Feel free to reach out on [LinkedIn](#)

All the best for your placements!